

For Project Passion, I decided to make a website for my job. This way, I could experiment more with coding, especially because I want to create an order screen for my job. I also see this project as another opportunity to dive into more research methods again.

Interview:

I first conducted an interview with my bosses at Ichi to understand their preferences and needs for the website. From this interview, I identified the following key points:

- * Alignment with social media: the website should reflect the aesthetic of their current Instagram posts. Clean and simple, but with pops of color to make the products stand out. For example, bright green is often used to highlight matcha products, while backgrounds remain neutral (white, grey, black). Captions on their posts are usually bold and inviting, which should also be reflected in the tone of the website.

- * Style preferences: my boss preferred a minimalistic and modern look that fits their product offering (desserts, matcha, coffee), but he was open to new ideas. However his wife, who co-manages the café, often leans toward a cuter, cozier aesthetic. This created a bit of uncertainty about the final visual direction, but they were open to seeing both styles.

- * Target audience: the main audience for Ichi is people aged 15-25, as reflected in their social media strategy which follows online trends, especially on TikTok and Instagram. However, due to the popularity of matcha and coffee, people aged 25+ also visit regularly.

- * Functional requirements: the website doesn't need complex features. My boss emphasized the importance of keeping the site simple, clear and user-friendly, focused on showing the menu, contact information and opening hours. He did not want hidden features or too many extras.

Based on these insights, I aimed to create a simple website that includes the most important functions to represent Ichi effectively. I wanted to explore a fitting visual style, which could either lean toward a cosy and cute aesthetic or a more simplistic and modern one. I planned to user-test the site with a younger demographic, specifically people aged 15-25 who enjoy visiting cafés and matcha- or coffee bars.

Even though my boss advised against adding too many extras or hidden features, I suggested implementing a feature where customers could place online orders for desserts or drinks. He agreed that this would be a good and fun addition to the site.

Competitive Research:

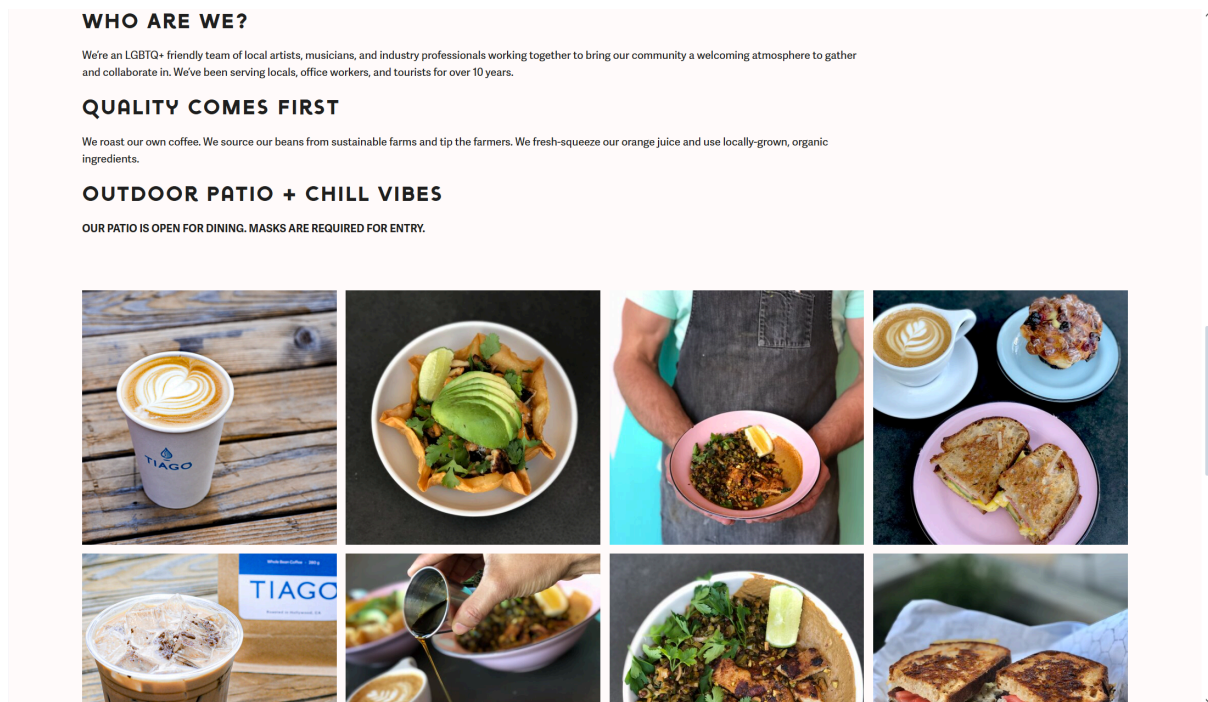
I wanted to conduct competitive research to find inspiration for what a café would typically need in a website, as well as to gather general ideas for design and functionality. I came across a website that featured various café websites and took note of some important elements that contribute to a strong and effective café site.

- * The layout should be clean and easy to navigate.
- * The color scheme should feel warm and inviting, evoking the atmosphere of a cozy café where people can relax and enjoy their drinks.
- * The content should be well-written and engaging, clearly highlighting the café's unique features and what sets it apart.
- * Photography should reflect the overall vibe of the café and showcase the appeal of the food and drinks.
- * Most importantly, the website should stay focused on its main goal(s): helping the visitor, whether that means providing clear information, easy navigation or enticing visuals.

[Source by **SiteBuilderReport**]

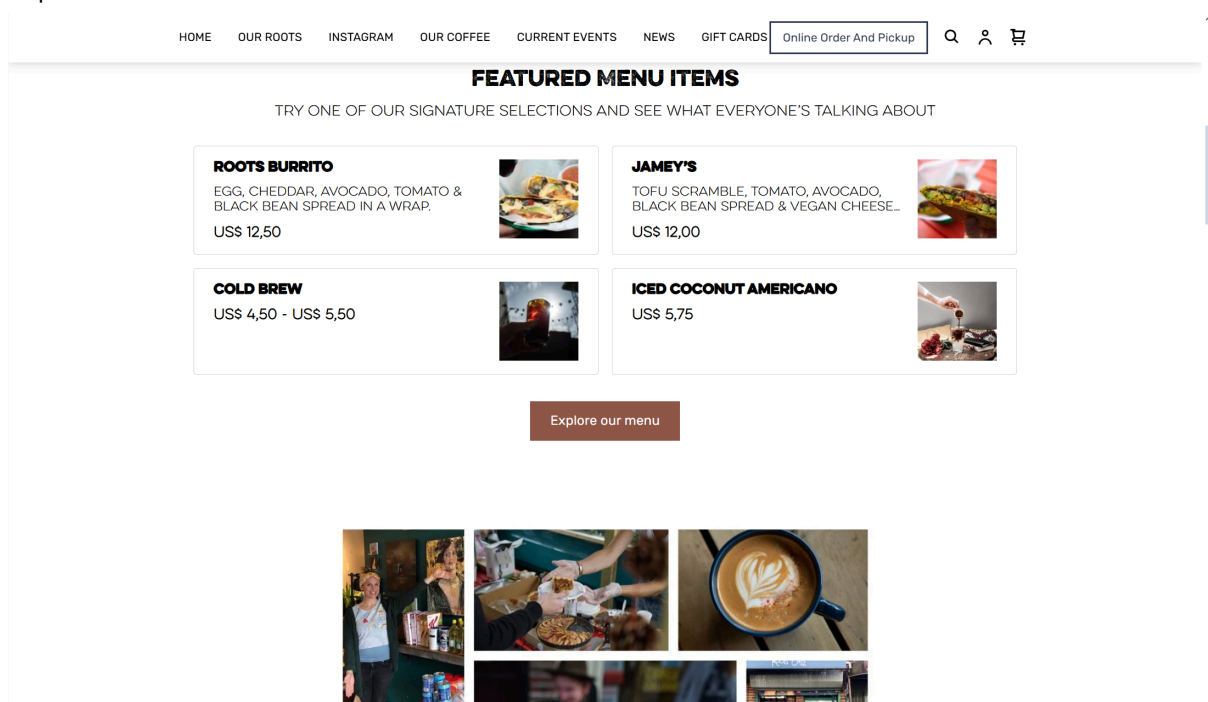
With the bullet points mentioned above, I picked out four different sites I liked and compared them to each other. Below are some examples of points I wanted to implement on the Ichi site as well, along with a screenshot of the café sites I used as examples.

* (Big) pictures of their food and drinks to make their products stand out.



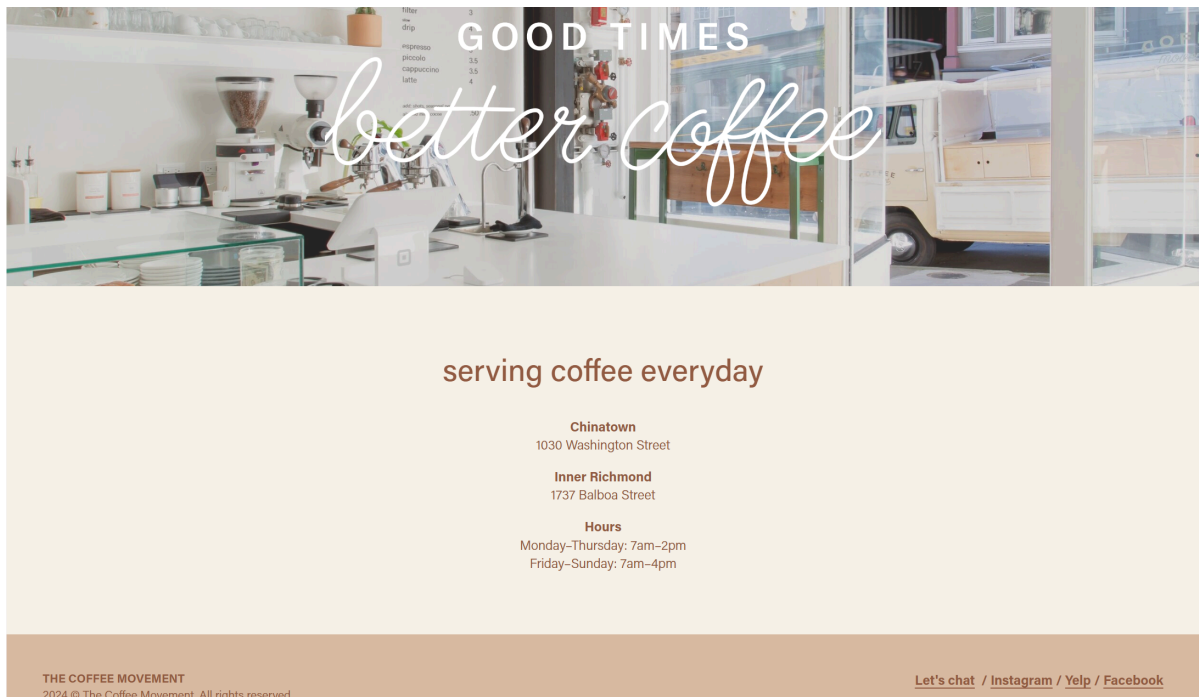
[Source by **Tiago Coffee**]

* Visually showing items from the menu again on the site to encourage visitors to explore the full menu.



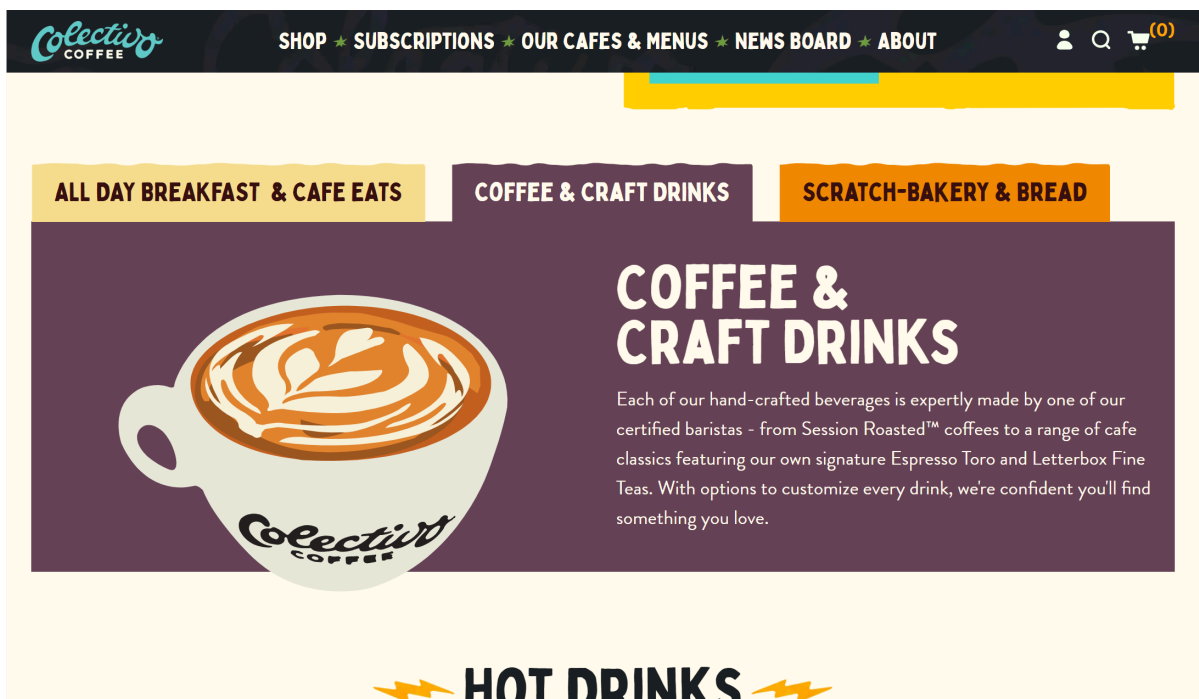
[Source by **Roots Cafe Brooklyn**]

* Mentioning their most important information on the site (address, contact and socials) using a clear and simple layout, so it's easy for customers to find.



[Source by **The Coffee Movement**]

* Giving the site a personal touch through brand-specific colors, symbols or aesthetics to make it more memorable.



[Source by **Colectivo Coffee**]

Logo:

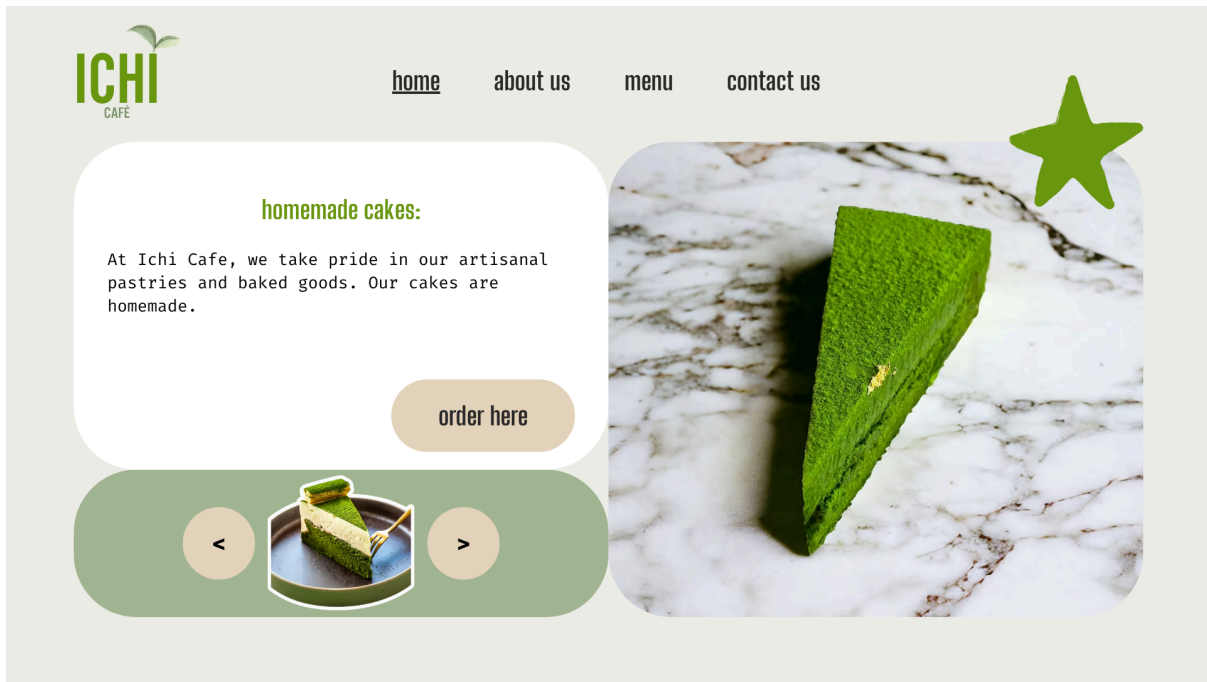
Because Ichi already had a logo, I chose to stick with their simplistic style by using a clean font like "Alternate Gothic N2", but added a touch of green and a leaf element to the "i" to make it look like the leaf is growing out of the letter. This design choice emphasizes the meaning of "Ichi" and connects it to their key ingredient, matcha (made from tea leaves). "Ichi" means "one" in Japanese, symbolizing being number one. Growth is essential to reaching that goal, which is represented by the growing leaf.



Prototype:

Because I only had two weeks and my bosses wouldn't have time for multiple meetings, I started with a general homepage layout in a cute and cosy style. I kept it simplistic, but added a personal touch using beige tones and light green to emphasize matcha, Ichi's key product. I included a large dessert photo, a short description linking Ichi to baked goods and a dessert bar where customers can scroll through items as a preview of the full menu. To enhance the cute feel, I added green stickers to highlight the matcha and used rounded blocks and bars for a softer look.

For fonts, I used "Big Shoulders Display" for links, buttons and titles, and "Fira Code" for the main text. Both simple but distinct. This layout was intended to preview the design and get initial feedback from my bosses.



[FEEDBACK 1 HIGHLIGHTS]

My boss liked the overall design, but gave some key points for improvement.

[WHAT HE LIKED]

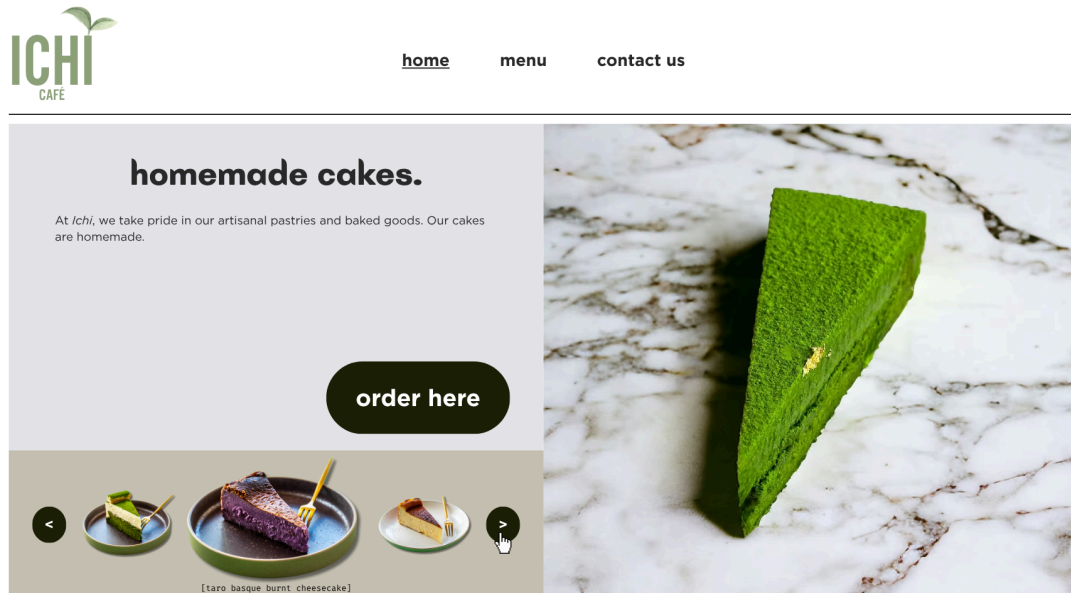
- * The simplicity of the design.
- * The use of separate blocks and bars instead of a single long page: it made the site more fun in his opinion.
- * The small preview of Ichi's menu items.

[WHAT HE WANTED CHANGED]

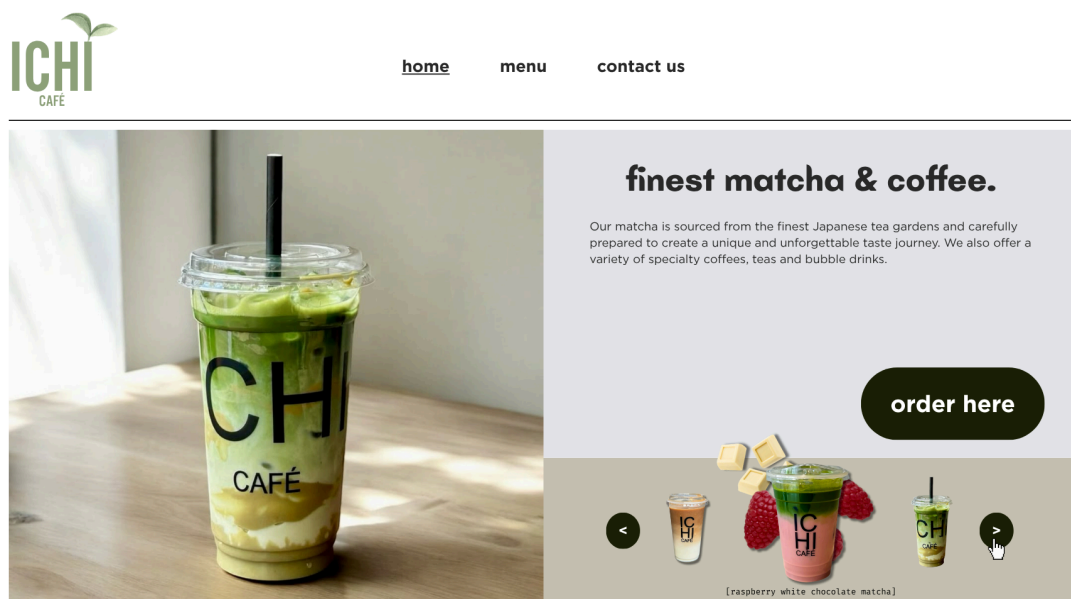
- * He changed his mind about the cute and cosy vibe and preferred a more modern and simplistic style: still warm, not cold. A mix of cold and warm colors (not just white, grey, black) could help.
- * He wanted a clearer preview of multiple menu items, not just one in the bar.
- * He found the about us page unnecessary. A clear description on the homepage and a contact page would be enough, alongside the menu page.

I decided to keep the layout, but adjusted the color palette, shapes and font. I used a mix of white, grey, black, and beige/brown colors. Lighter for backgrounds and blocks, darker colors for text. I relied on the product photos to keep the more cosy vibe, thanks to their bright colors. I added more items to the preview bar and removed the rounded shapes for a cleaner, more modern style.

For fonts, I still chose simplicity, but made the titles and buttons stand out more using "Batangas", a simple yet fun font with both round and edgy shapes that visually match the growing leaf in the Ichi logo. For body text, I used the simpler "Gotham" font.



With this style in mind, I completed the entire homepage by also adding a section at the bottom with different drinks and their information. This section includes the telephone number, email address, address, opening hours and links to Ichi's social media.



[home](#)[menu](#)[contact us](#)

simplicity & commitment.

At *ichi*, we celebrate the simplicity of exceptional ingredients and the excellence of their preparation. We invite you to enjoy our simple atmosphere and friendly service as you savor our delicious beverages and homemade treats.

visit us today!

contact

123-456-7890
info@ichicafe.nl

Jan van Lieshoutstraat 36
5611EE Eindhoven

opening hours

Monday - Sunday: 11am - 19pm
Friday: 11am - 21pm



Last but not least, I made the menu page. I used square pictures, with the name of the product and a short description.

[home](#)[menu](#)[contact us](#)

signature matcha chocolate cake

Our signature matcha chocolate cake made with organic matcha from Uji, Japan, the birthplace of matcha.



matcha basque burnt cheesecake

Creamy Basque cheesecake made with our organic Japanese ceremonial matcha.



taro basque burnt cheesecake

Creamy burnt cheesecake with taro.



[FEEDBACK 2 HIGHLIGHTS]

I showed my prototype to my boss using the preferred style and he seemed very happy with it. He reviewed the homepage and didn't see any flaws, but suggested that the menu page could include additional information, like Ichi's recommended products. This would make the site feel more personal and help customers choose a dessert. Another thing he mentioned was that he liked the fonts, but still wanted to try an even more simple font for both the titles and text, because he wanted a more mature approach for the simplistic aesthetic. I decided to add a simple, small bar to some products and pictures to highlight additional information about certain items. Even though he still needs to take proper pictures of the drinks, he mentioned that creating separate tabs for desserts and drinks in the future could be handy. I also decided to go for one simple font later on with coding, "Montserrat", which was clean and simple without crazy roundings or shapes.

[home](#)[menu](#)[contact us](#)[cakes](#)[drinks](#)

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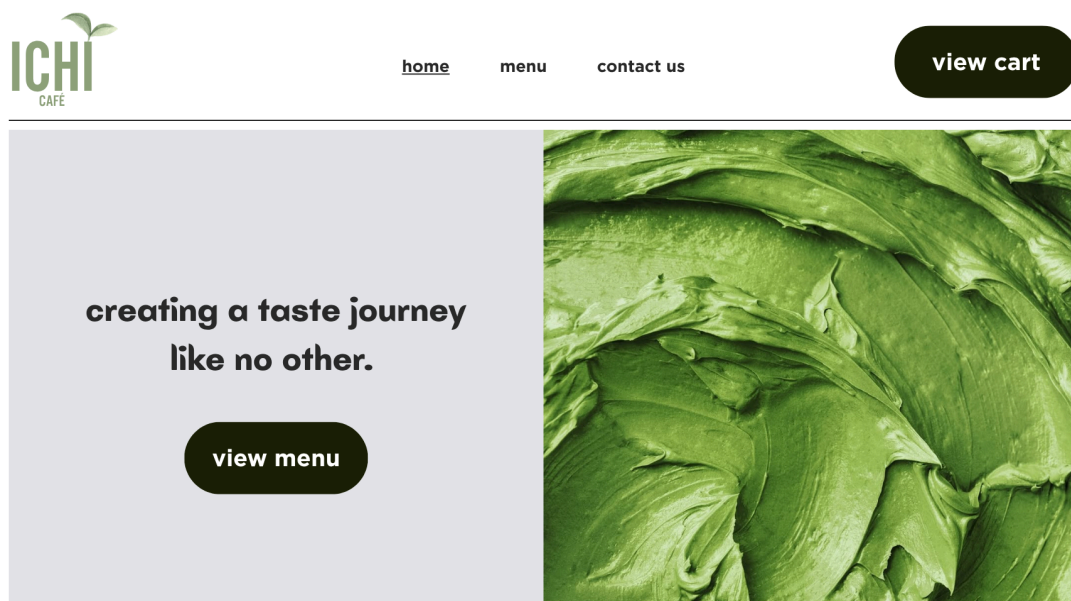
User-testing:

I decided to have a loyal Ichi customer user-test the prototype. In addition, I asked two other café-goers (aged 24 and 18) to test the site as well, to gain more insight into areas for improvement. I sat next to them during testing and encouraged them to think out loud while answering questions about visual appeal, readability, navigation and potential improvements.

[FEEDBACK 3 HIGHLIGHTS]

Overall, the testers appreciated the website's design. It was simple, clear and easy to read. One tester noted that the homepage immediately started with the cakes: while not necessarily bad, they felt a separate introduction or welcome section could improve the flow. Another tester suggested that the order button (which was not implemented yet) should also appear on every page, preferably in the header, where there was still space.

Based on this feedback, I added a dedicated introduction section with a button linking to the menu and placed a big cart button in the header for easier access.





[home](#) [menu](#) [contact us](#)

[view cart](#)

[cakes](#) [drinks](#)



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Coding:

To explore LO2 more deeply in this project, I created several key code snippets that demonstrate my understanding. I built my website using HTML, CSS and JavaScript, and documented my progress and updates on GitLab.

Want to view this repository with my code snippets? [Click here.](#)

The screenshot shows a GitLab repository for a project named 'Ichi'. The repository is owned by 'Ngo,Saomai S.M.' and is on the 'main' branch. The repository contains several files: 'images', 'README.md', 'cart.html', 'index.css', 'index.html', 'menu.css', and 'menu.html'. The 'README.md' file is selected, showing its content. The repository has 7 commits, 1 branch, 0 tags, and 55.2 MiB of project storage. The repository was created on June 21, 2025.

Name	Last commit	Last update
images	Made the cart.html, checked the J...	5 minutes ago
README.md	Changed the README.	1 day ago
cart.html	Made the cart.html, checked the J...	5 minutes ago
index.css	Made the cart.html, checked the J...	5 minutes ago
index.html	Made the cart.html, checked the J...	5 minutes ago
menu.css	Made the cart.html, checked the J...	5 minutes ago
menu.html	Made the cart.html, checked the J...	5 minutes ago

README.md

This is the website I made for Ichi.

Here, you can see the most important information about Ichi. There will be information about the products they sell, their contact info and it's possible to add their products in your own cart (can be seen as an ordering-screen). I used HTML, CSS and JavaScript to make these projects.

It's also possible to download my full document (PDF) of my portfolio, to see the iterations and other assignments described in full detail, besides the most important points of my different projects described on my portfolio site. You can download this PDF when clicking on any project, or when visiting the LUKS-page.

Want to view Ichi's website made by me? [Click here.](#)